IT HELP DESK – FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (EMPLOYEE EDITION)

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Field	Details
Document Title	IT Help Desk – Frequently Asked Questions (Employee Edition)
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HOW TO USE THIS FAQ

- **Search by keyword** (Ctrl+F) or browse categories
- Each answer includes: ✅ Quick fix + 🔗 Link to detailed guide + 📞 When to contact IT
- Updated monthly based on ticket analysis and employee feedback

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🔐 ACCESS & ACCOUNTS

Q: I forgot my password. How do I reset it?

Component	Details
✅ **Self-Service Reset**	1. Go to https://passwordreset.fwd.com 2. Enter your employee ID 3. Verify identity via Microsoft Authenticator app or SMS 4. Create new password (must meet complexity requirements)
🔗 **Detailed Guide**	KB-201: Password Reset Procedures
📞 **Contact IT If**	You no longer have access to registered MFA methods

Q: My account is locked. What should I do?

Component	Details
✅ **Immediate Steps**	1. Wait 15 minutes (auto-unlock after failed attempts) 2. Try self-service reset above 3. Ensure Caps Lock is OFF and keyboard layout is correct
🔗 **Reference**	KB-205: Account Lockout Resolution
📞 **Contact IT If**	Locked repeatedly without failed attempts (possible security event)

Q: How do I set up Microsoft Authenticator for MFA?

Component	Details
✅ **Setup Steps**	1. Install "Microsoft Authenticator" from App Store/Google Play 2. Go to https://mysignins.microsoft.com/security-info 3. Click "+ Add method" > Authenticator app > Follow QR code setup 4. Test with a sign-in to portal.fwd.com
🔗 **Video Tutorial**	2-min setup guide
⚠️ **Important**	Save backup codes in secure location (password manager)

🌐 NETWORK & CONNECTIVITY

Q: I can't connect to FWD-Secure Wi-Fi. Help!

Component	Details
✅ **Quick Fixes**	1. Toggle Airplane mode ON, then OFF 2. Forget network and re-add (Settings > Wi-Fi > Manage known networks) 3. Restart laptop and router (if working from home)
🔗 **Full Guide**	KB-101: Corporate Wi-Fi Setup
📞 **Contact IT If**	Certificate errors persist or network not visible

Q: My VPN (GlobalProtect) won't connect. What now?

Component	Details
✅ **Troubleshooting**	1. Confirm internet works (try browsing) 2. Update GlobalProtect via Company Portal app 3. Clear cache: Delete C:\Users%username%\AppData\Local\PaloAltoNetworks\GlobalProtect 4. Re-authenticate with Microsoft Authenticator approval
🔗 **Advanced Steps**	KB-115: VPN Troubleshooting
📞 **Contact IT If**	Error code -1001 or -2012 appears repeatedly

Q: Internet is slow on corporate network. How to diagnose?

Component	Details
✅ **Self-Checks**	1. Run speed test: https://speedtest.fwd.com (internal server) 2. Try wired connection if possible (rules out Wi-Fi issues) 3. Check for large downloads/updates running in background
🔗 **Diagnostic Guide**	KB-122: Network Performance
📞 **Contact IT If**	Speed <10 Mbps on wired connection during business hours

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💻 DEVICES & HARDWARE

Q: How do I set up my new work laptop?

Component	Details
✅ **First-Time Setup Checklist**	1. Connect to power and turn on 2. Sign in with FWD credentials (format: FWD\employee.id) 3. Complete Windows Hello setup (PIN or biometric) 4. Open Company Portal app > Install required apps 5. Connect to FWD-Secure Wi-Fi (see above) 6. Test Outlook and Teams
🔗 **Full Onboarding**	KB-301: New Device Setup
📞 **Contact IT If**	Device fails to enroll in Intune after 30 minutes

Q: My laptop is running very slow. What can I do?

Component	Details
✅ **Quick Performance Boost**	1. Restart your device (clears memory leaks) 2. Close unused browser tabs and applications 3. Run Disk Cleanup: Search "Disk Cleanup" > Clean system files 4. Check for updates: Settings > Windows Update > Install all
🔗 **Advanced Optimization**	KB-410: Performance Tuning
📞 **Contact IT If**	Slowness persists after restart and updates

Q: External monitor not detected. How to fix?

Component	Details
✅ **Connection Steps**	1. Check cable connections (HDMI/USB-C) at both ends 2. Press Win + P > Select "Extend" or "Duplicate" 3. Update display drivers via Company Portal > Updates 4. Try different port or cable if available
🔗 **Multi-Monitor Guide**	KB-425: Display Setup
📞 **Contact IT If**	Monitor works with other devices (possible hardware fault)

📧 MICROSOFT 365 APPLICATIONS

Q: Outlook not syncing emails. What to check?

Component	Details
✅ **Immediate Actions**	1. Check Service Health: https://admin.microsoft.com > Health (service incident?) 2. Restart Outlook in Safe Mode: outlook.exe /safe 3. Rebuild profile if needed (Control Panel > Mail > Profiles)
🔗 **Full Resolution**	KB-501: Outlook Sync Issues
📞 **Contact IT If**	Issue affects multiple devices or persists >1 hour

Q: How do I install Microsoft Teams / Office apps?

Component	Details
✅ **Approved Installation Method**	1. Open Company Portal app (pre-installed on corporate devices) 2. Search for "Microsoft Teams" or "Office" 3. Click Install > Follow prompts 4. Sign in with FWD credentials when launched
⚠️ **Warning**	Do NOT download from public websites – security risk
🔗 **Software Catalog**	Approved Applications List
📞 **Contact IT If**	Installation fails with error code

Q: Excel / Word keeps crashing. How to fix?

Component	Details
✅ **Stability Steps**	1. Update Office: Open any app > File > Account > Update Options > Update Now 2. Disable hardware graphics acceleration: File > Options > Advanced > Display 3. Run Office Repair: Settings > Apps > Microsoft 365 > Modify > Quick Repair
🔗 **Advanced Troubleshooting**	KB-520: Office App Crashes
📞 **Contact IT If**	Crash occurs with blank file (possible profile corruption)

🖨️ PRINTING & PERIPHERALS

Q: How do I add a network printer?

Component	Details
✅ **Auto-Discovery Method (Recommended)**	1. Ensure connected to FWD-Secure Wi-Fi or wired network 2. Open Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Printers & scanners 3. Click "Add device" – FWD printers should appear automatically

Component	Details
	4. Select your nearest printer (e.g., "FWD-SG-LVL3-HP01")
✅ **Manual Add (If auto fails)**	Printer path: \print.fwd.com\PrinterName Use Windows authentication when prompted
🔗 **Printer Directory**	Office Printer Locations Map
📞 **Contact IT If**	Printer shows "Offline" after adding

Q: My keyboard/mouse not working. Quick fixes?

Component	Details
✅ **Hardware Troubleshooting**	**Wireless:** Replace batteries / Re-pair via Bluetooth settings **Wired:** Try different USB port (avoid hubs) **Test:** Test on another device to isolate hardware vs. software issue
🔗 **Peripheral Guide**	KB-610: Input Device Support
📞 **Contact IT If**	Device works elsewhere but not on work laptop (driver issue)

🚨 WHEN TO CONTACT IT HELP DESK

✅ Contact Us Immediately If:

Priority	Situation
🔴 **Critical**	You suspect a security incident (phishing email, lost device)
🔴 **Critical**	Customer-facing system is down
🟠 **High**	You cannot access critical tools for your role
🟠 **High**	Error message includes "Contact your administrator"

📞 Contact Methods

Method	Details
Phone	1234
Email	[IT Support Email]
Portal	[Service Portal URL]

ℹ️ **Before Contacting, Please Have Ready:**

Information Required	Where to Find It
Employee ID and department	Your employee badge/HR system
Device name	Settings > System > About
Exact error message	Screenshot if possible
Steps already tried	List troubleshooting attempts

DOCUMENT FOOTER

Item	Details
Next Review	1 April 2026
Feedback	Rate this FAQ at https://feedback.fwd.com/it-faq
Document End	—

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